Keeno Smith

Full-Stack Software Engineer | Backend & Distributed Systems

React · TypeScript · Python · REST APIs · SQL · Cloud-Native Applications

Cape Town · Johannesburg

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Professional Summary

Full-Stack Software Engineer with 6+ years of software and digital engineering experience, designing and developing web applications, backend services and integrated business systems. Work across React, TypeScript, JavaScript, Python, Node.js and SQL, with additional experience in Angular, Java/Spring Boot, ASP.NET Core and Go. Build maintainable user interfaces, reliable APIs and data-backed workflows.

Experience spans full-stack application engineering, AI-enabled software development, business technology consulting and technical evaluation. Focus on application architecture, authentication and authorisation, database modelling, API integrations, event-driven processing, automated testing and operational reliability. Translate requirements into practical solutions with attention to performance, security and maintainability.

Technical Skills

Frontend engineering: React, Angular, TypeScript, JavaScript, Vite, React Router, Tailwind CSS, HTML, CSS, responsive design, state management

Backend engineering: Node.js, Express, NestJS, Python (3+ years), FastAPI, Java, Spring Boot, C#, ASP.NET Core, Go, REST APIs, OpenAPI, WebSockets

Databases and persistence: PostgreSQL, Prisma, JPA, TimescaleDB, MongoDB, Mongoose, Redis, SQLite, SQL, schema design, transactions, data modelling

Architecture and integration: Full-stack architecture, API integrations, JWT, authentication, RBAC, Kafka/Redpanda, RabbitMQ, event-driven systems, webhooks, idempotency, background jobs

Testing and delivery: Unit and integration testing, automated validation, Git, GitHub Actions, CI/CD, Docker, Docker Compose, debugging, logging, API documentation

Cloud, reliability and AI: Azure, AWS, Google Cloud, Kubernetes, OpenTelemetry, Prometheus, Grafana, distributed systems, LLM APIs, RAG, intelligent automation

Experience

Python and Full-Stack Engineer in AI Training and Evaluation

Turing / OpenTrain AI | February 2026 – Present

Contribute Python and JavaScript/TypeScript software engineering to AI training and technical evaluation workflows, with emphasis on code correctness, reasoning quality, testing and maintainability.

- Develop, review and debug programming solutions; verify correctness, test coverage, edge cases and maintainable structure across Python and TypeScript.
- Evaluate technical implementations against specifications, documenting defects, security concerns and reproducibility gaps with clear code-level reasoning.
- Prepare structured implementation examples and code-quality feedback for supervised fine-tuning (SFT), RLHF and model evaluation workflows.

Experience Continued

AI Engineer

kailor | February 2025 – Present

Engineer full-stack AI-enabled applications connecting frontend experiences, backend services, persistent project workflows and business automation, from requirements through implementation.

- Design Python and TypeScript services, REST APIs, data processing workflows and model-integrated application features.
- Build enquiry, administration and recurring-task applications with persistent state, business rules and third-party API integrations.
- Translate process requirements into user flows, service contracts and maintainable software or automation solutions.
- Apply authentication, permissions, input validation, retries, exception handling, audit trails and human review across application workflows.
- Test integrated features, investigate failures and document architectural decisions, delivery risks and maintenance trade-offs.

Full-Stack Software Engineer & AI Publisher

kailor | June 2022 – January 2025

Developed full-stack web applications and digital publishing systems, connecting user interfaces with backend services, content operations, persistent data and integrated business tools.

- Built React/JavaScript interfaces, Node.js features, REST APIs, authentication, data models and end-to-end application workflows.
- Developed publishing and content-management workflows, integrating external services and automating recurring operational tasks.
- Improved stability and usability through integration testing, debugging, defect resolution and iterative feature delivery.

Technical and Digital Operations Lead and Co-Founder

Firstdaes Entertainment | January 2020 – June 2022

Co-founded an entertainment business and led its digital systems, workflow design and technology-enabled operations.

- Translated operational needs into technical requirements; managed implementation, testing and troubleshooting of digital services.
- Integrated communications, marketing and analytics tooling; used performance data and operational feedback to refine processes.

Contract Specialist in Technical Content and Documentation

3Play Media | February 2016 – January 2020

- Reviewed, transcribed and edited specialist material covering software, cloud, networking and cybersecurity, preserving technical terminology and accuracy.
- Resolved ambiguous content and maintained quality and delivery standards across assignments for enterprise technology subject matter.

Education

Stellenbosch University: Generative AI Mini Bootcamp | June – September 2026

HyperionDev: Full-Stack Software Engineering and Web Development | January – June 2026

University of South Africa: BSc Computer Science | 2017 – 2022

Selected Projects

Independent full-stack projects demonstrating web applications, backend APIs, data persistence and distributed-system reliability.

Real-Time Logistics & Fleet Operations Platform

React · TypeScript · Go · REST/WebSockets · Redpanda · PostgreSQL/TimescaleDB · Redis

Built an end-to-end dispatcher platform with live fleet maps, delivery planning, assignment and recovery workflows. Connected React interfaces to Go REST and WebSocket services, streaming GPS updates through Redpanda and persisting history in TimescaleDB. Implemented alerts, transactional reassignment, durable state, restart recovery and operational metrics.

Repository: https://github.com/keenosmith-del/real-time-logistics-and-fleet-ops

Field Service & Asset Maintenance Management Platform

Angular · ASP.NET Core · C# · .NET MAUI · PostgreSQL · SQLite · JWT · Docker

Developed a field-service platform spanning an Angular supervisor dashboard, ASP.NET Core APIs and a .NET MAUI technician application. Implemented asset and work-order workflows, role-based access, offline SQLite outbox synchronisation, evidence capture, conflict handling and audit history. Validated API, database and offline replay behaviour with automated tests.

Repository: https://github.com/keenosmith-del/field-service-and-asset-maintenance

Telecommunications Billing & Subscription Management

Angular · Java · Spring Boot · PostgreSQL · Kafka · Redis · Flyway · Docker

Engineered customer and administrator portals for subscription management, usage metering, billing and invoicing. Integrated Spring Boot APIs with PostgreSQL, Kafka and Redis; implemented transactional billing, idempotent event processing, reconciliation, access controls and PDF invoices. Verified large-event ingestion and replay against a local containerised stack.

Repository: https://github.com/keenosmith-del/telecomms-billing-management

Distributed Systems Reliability & Chaos Engineering

React · TypeScript · Go · PostgreSQL · RabbitMQ · Redis · Docker · Prometheus

Built an e-commerce workload and reliability dashboard covering order lifecycle, durable sagas, idempotent transactions and outbox messaging. Integrated REST/SSE services with real telemetry and controlled fault experiments, then validated recovery, transactional consistency, bounded retries and isolated PostgreSQL backup restoration.

Repository: https://github.com/keenosmith-del/sre-chaos-engineering

Selected Credentials and Professional Development

Microsoft AI: AI-103 — Azure AI Apps and Agents Developer Associate | Completed October 2026; AI-500 | In progress; Microsoft Applied Skills — Defender XDR

Generative AI and engineering: WeThinkCode_ Generative AI for Professionals | October 2026; Generative AI for Software Engineers; AI Course for Developers; AWS AI/ML Scholars AI Practitioner and AI Programmer Nanodegree

Automation and related training: n8n Workflow Automation and AI; Microsoft × Founderz Cyber Genius; Founderz Agent Architect (enrolled); IBM Enterprise Design Thinking Practitioner; Make Agentic AI Work for You; Google Cloud Kubernetes